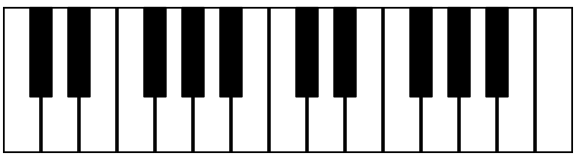
Read at Sight

A graded sight-reading course for piano

Volume 2 - Moving Hands



Middle C

Your hands leave home: shifts, stretches, new keys and minor keys, with legato, staccato and dynamics to bring the music to life.

Exercises generated to graded rules; pieces are original or public domain.

How to use this book

What is new in Volume 2

In Volume 1 each exercise stayed in one hand position. Now the hands move. A finger number in the middle of an exercise means: shift your hand now, so that finger lands on that note. You will also read slurs, staccato dots and dynamics, and play in G major, F major and three minor keys. Start this book when you can read both clefs in C and G positions, hands together, with eighth notes, rests and ties.

The five rules

1. Never stop: keep the beat going, even after a wrong note. 2. Count out loud and use a metronome at the speed shown. 3. Keep your eyes on the music, not your hands. 4. Read the shape: up, down, or the same, and by how much. 5. Play each exercise once, tick its box, and move on. Come back only after a few weeks.

Before every exercise: 10 seconds

Check the clef and time signature. Find the first note and its finger number. Scan for the highest and lowest note, and for any bar that repeats an earlier one. Then count one bar in and play.

How each unit is laid out

A unit opens with what is new, a keyboard picture of the hand position, and reading tips. Then come Parts A, B and C, which grow slightly harder. Pieces come next, and the unit ends with a checkpoint that tells you when to move on.

A daily routine (15-20 minutes)

Warm up by playing the five notes of the hand position up and down, saying their names (2 minutes). Read 6-10 new exercises, one pass each (10 minutes). Play one piece, aiming for steady and musical (5 minutes).

Contents

Each unit adds exactly one new idea to everything before it.

Unit 1 Moving the Hand 4
Hand shifts between C and G positions; a finger number marks every move

Unit 2 Stretching
Reaching one key beyond the position with the thumb or little finger

Unit 3 Dotted Quarter Notes
The dotted quarter note followed by an eighth: 'long-short'

Unit 4 Legato and Staccato
Slurs (smooth and connected) and staccato dots (short and detached)

Unit 5 Loud and Soft
Dynamics: p, mp, mf, f; getting louder and softer

Unit 6 G Major
Key signature of one sharp (F-sharp); G and D positions

Unit 7 F Major
Key signature of one flat (B-flat); F and C positions

Unit 8 A Minor
Minor keys; A minor, the relative minor of C major

Unit 9 E Minor and D Minor
The relative minors of G major (E minor) and F major (D minor)

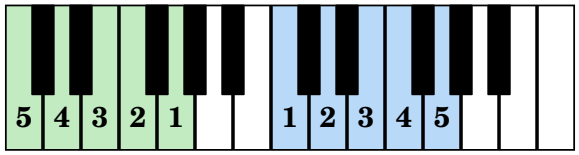
Unit 10 Review
Everything in Volume 2 together

Unit 1

Moving the Hand

New: Hand shifts between C and G positions; a finger number marks every move

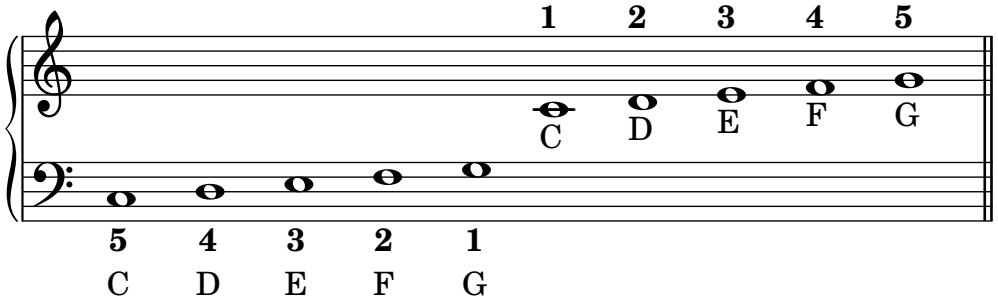
So far each exercise kept the hand in one place. Real music moves. In this unit each hand moves between two homes, C position and G position. A finger number in the middle of a line is your signal: move the hand so that finger lands on that note.

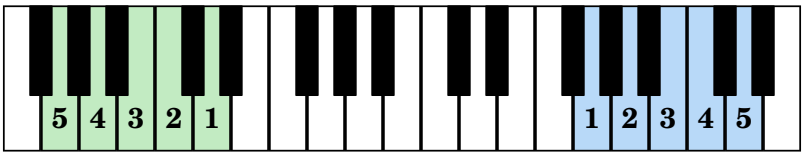


Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

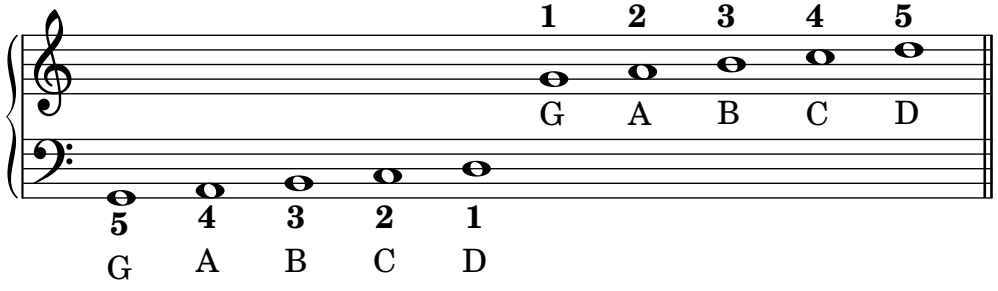




Middle C

Left hand G position and Right hand G position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Shift signals

A finger number appears on the first note after every move. A 1 on G in the right hand means the thumb goes to G: you are now in G position.

Move early

Move the hand during the note before the shift, or during a rest, so you arrive in time. The beat does not wait for the hand.

Where the positions meet

The right hand's two positions overlap on G: finger 5 in C position, finger 1 in G position. The left hand's overlap on C and D.

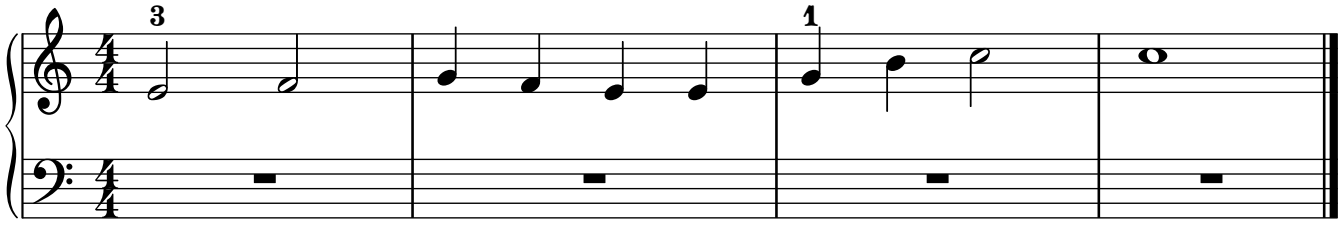
Reading tips

1. In your 10-second scan, find every finger number. Each one after the first is a shift.
2. Look at the note under each finger number and picture where your hand goes before you start.
3. Keep your eyes on the music while you move. Feel the distance rather than looking down.
4. If a shift goes wrong, keep counting and rejoin on the next note you can.

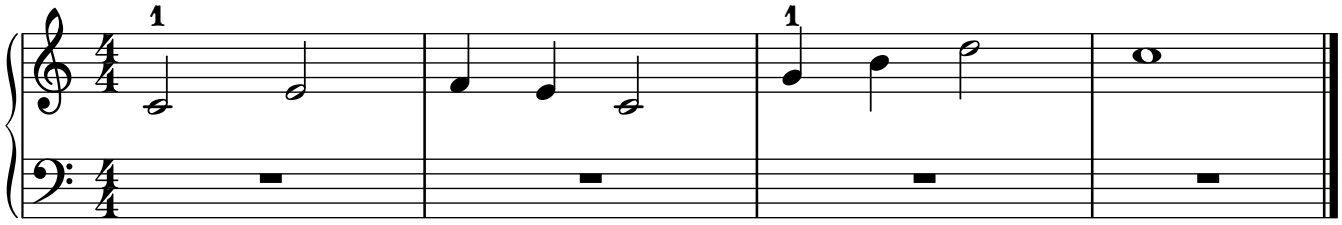
Part A: Right hand moves between C and G ♩ = 60

The right hand moves between C position and G position. Watch for finger numbers. Metronome 60.

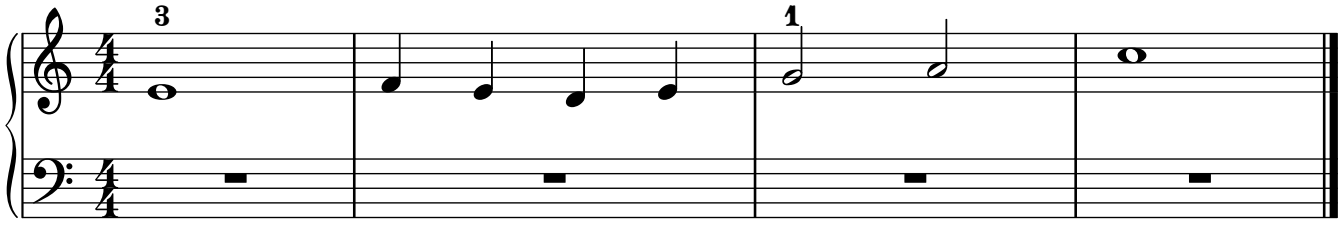
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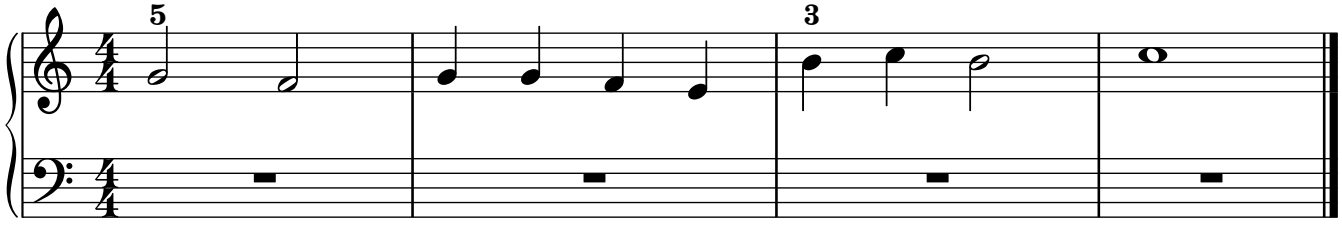
☐ **1.2**



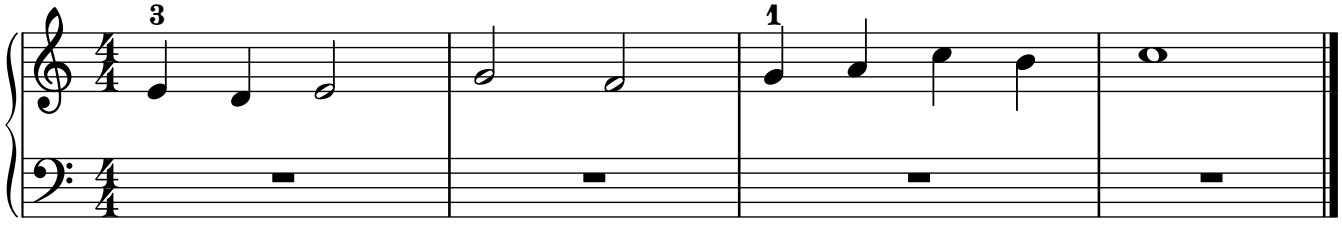
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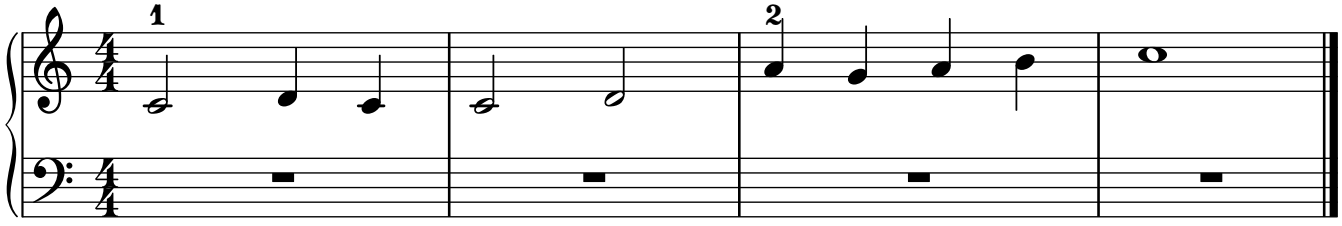
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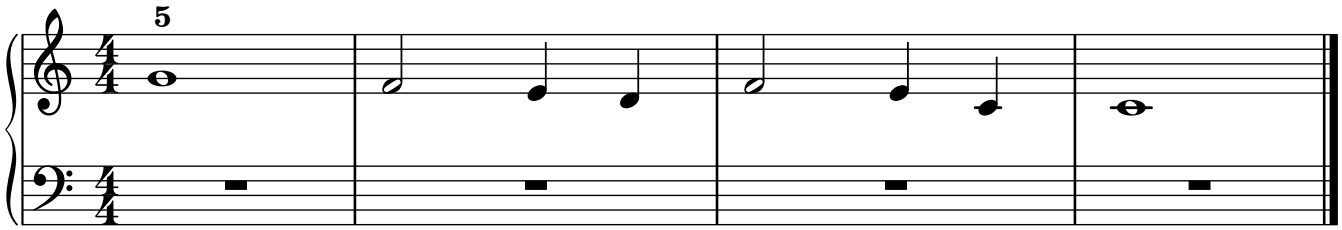


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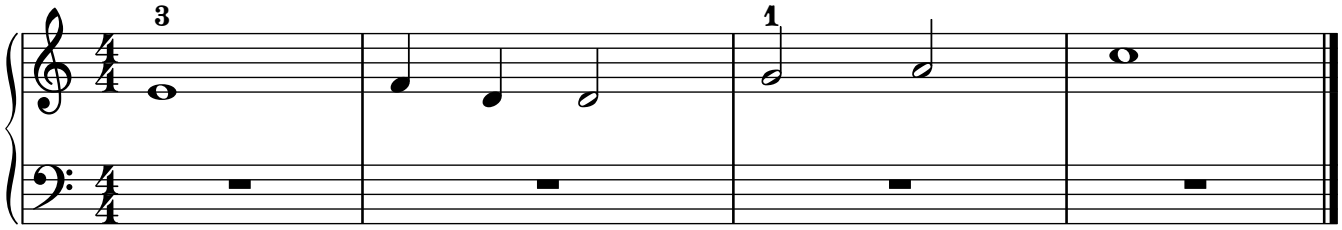
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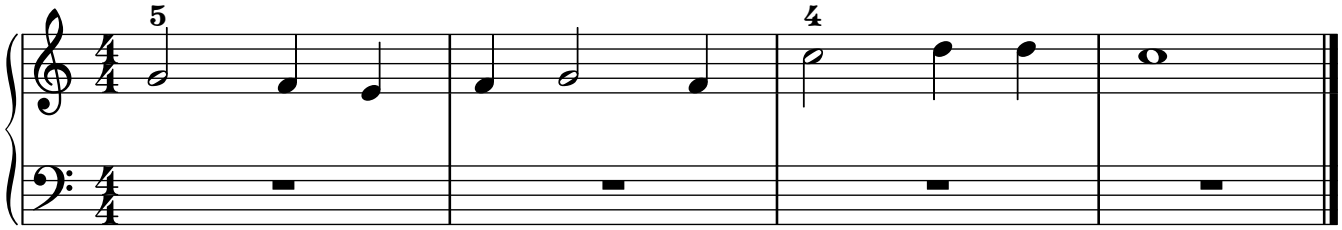
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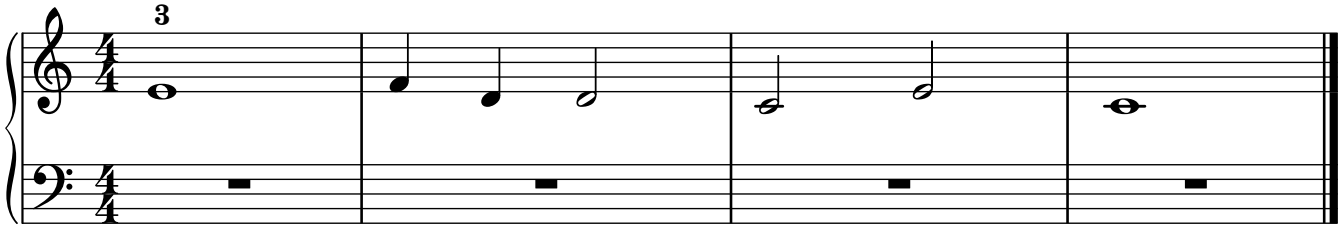


☐ **1.8**



☐ **1.9**



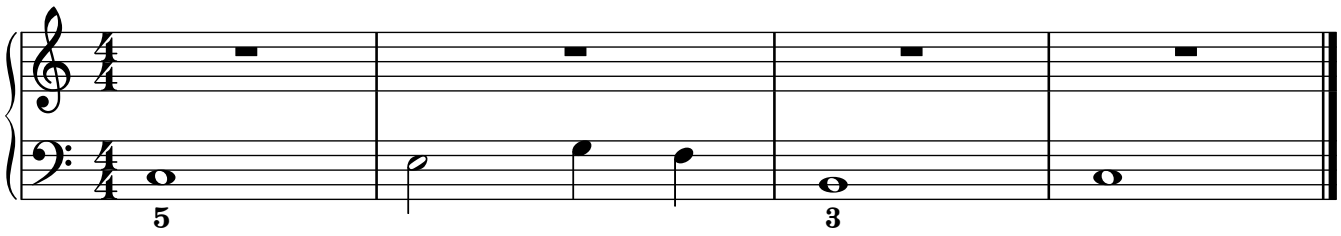
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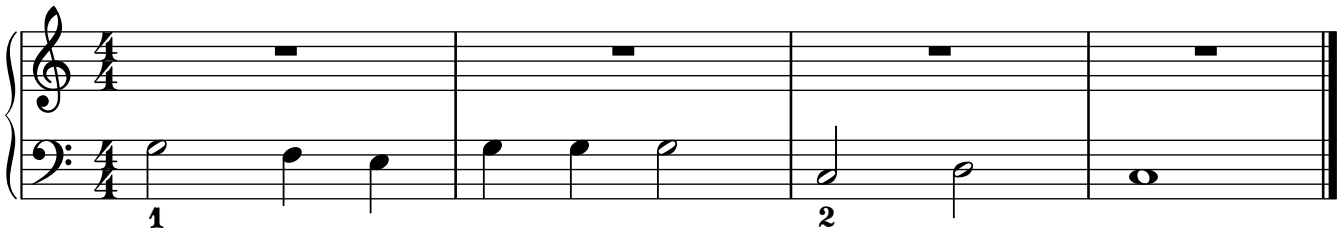
Part B: Left hand moves between C and G ♩= 60

The left hand moves between C position (C in the second space) and G position (G on the bottom line).

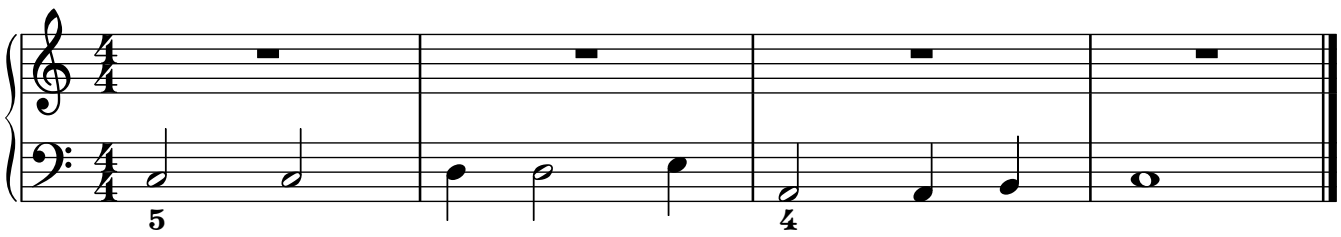
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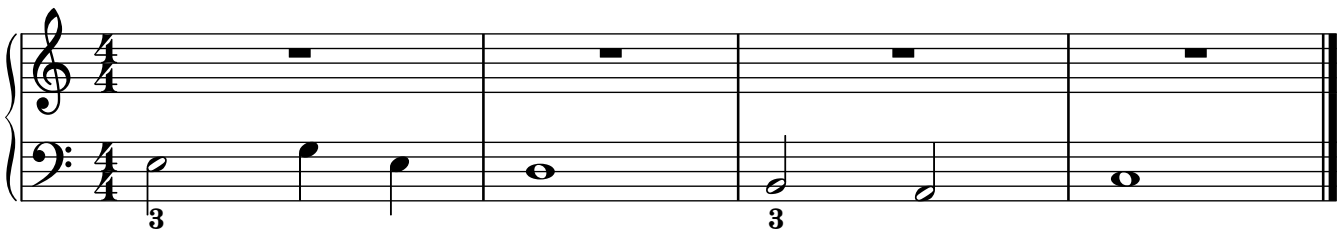
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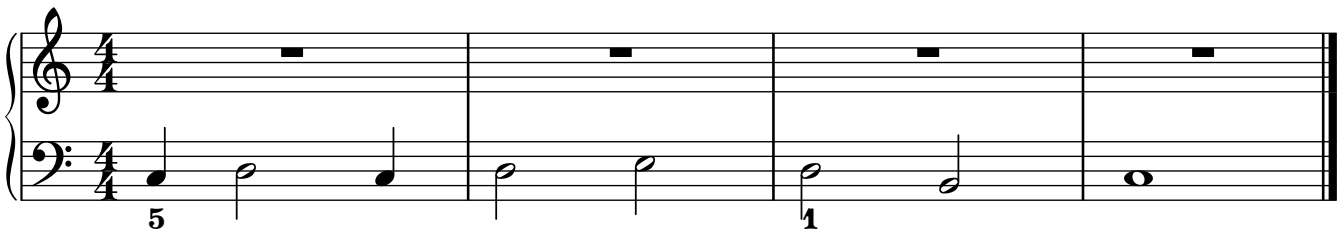
☐ **1.13**



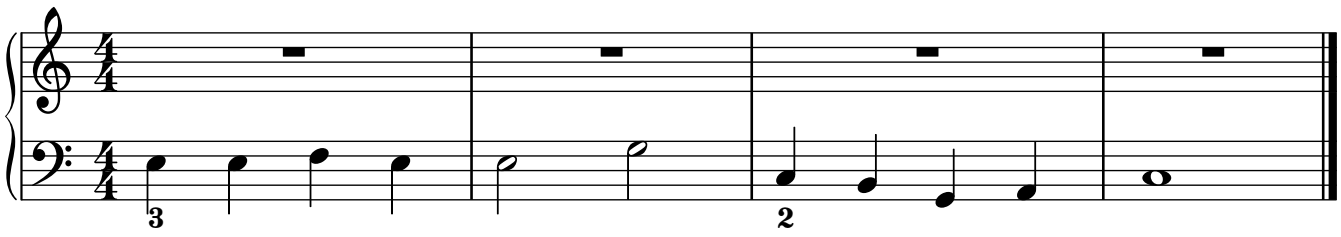
☐ **1.14**



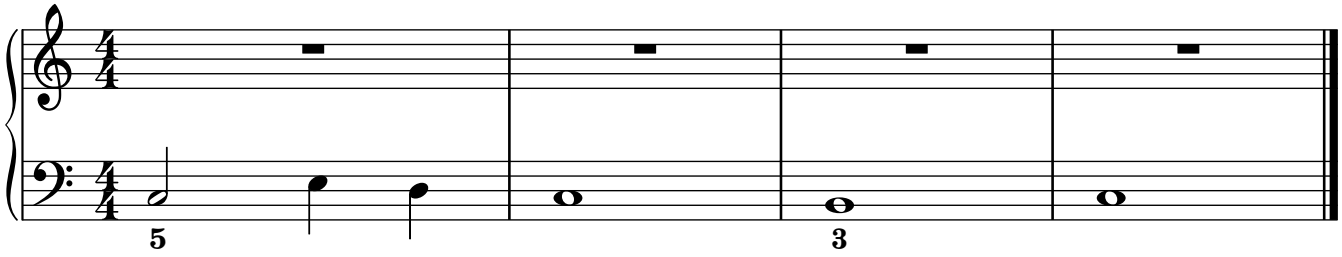
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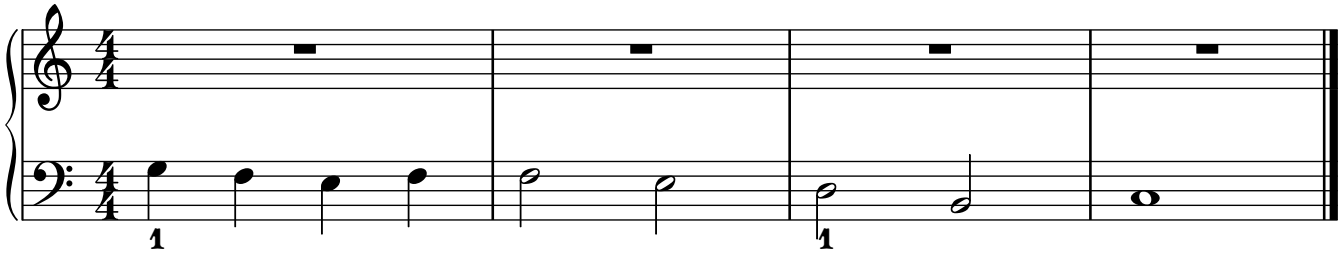
☐ **1.16**



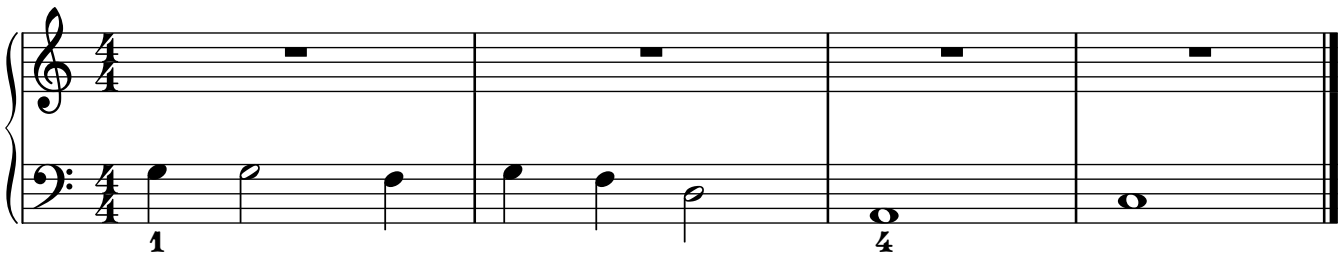
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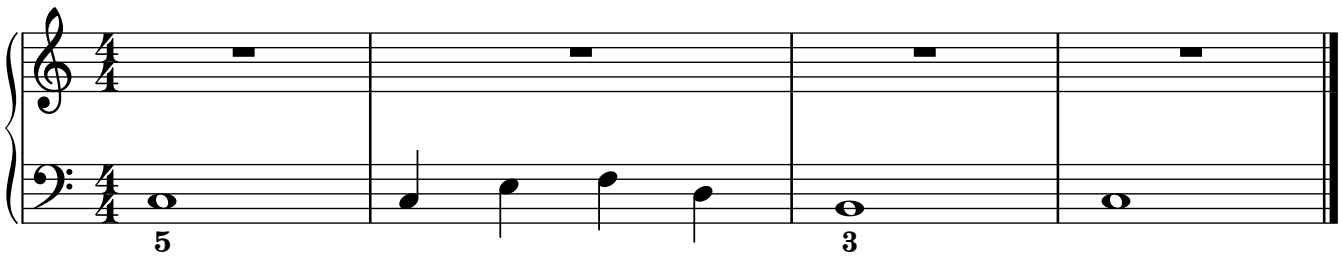
☐ **1.18**



☐ **1.19**



☐ **1.20**

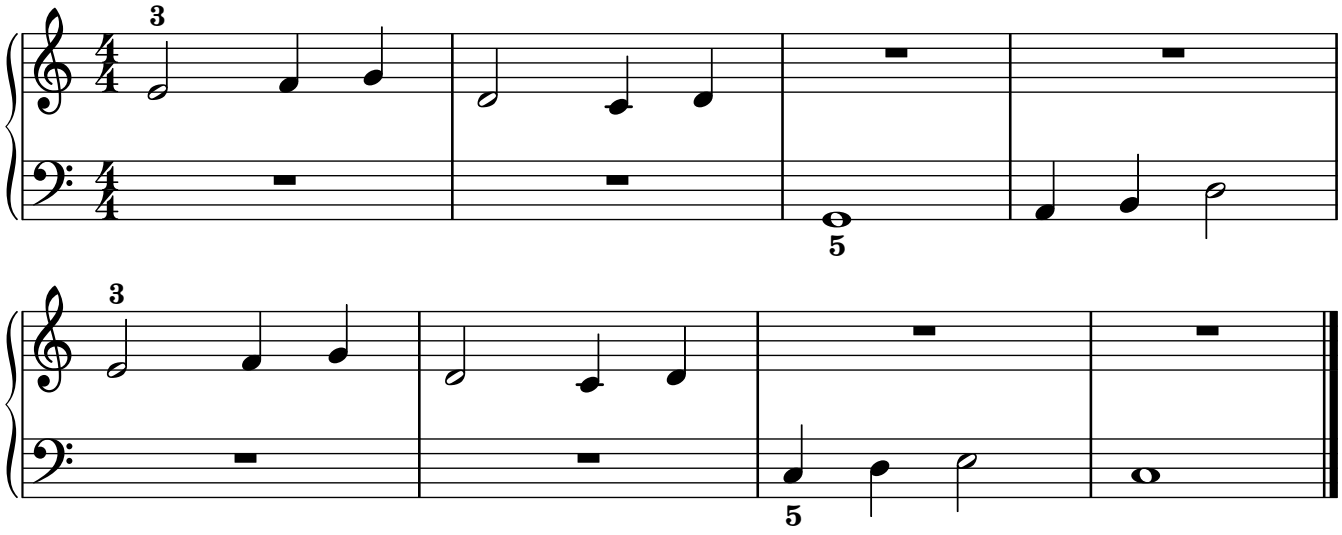


Part C: Both hands on the move

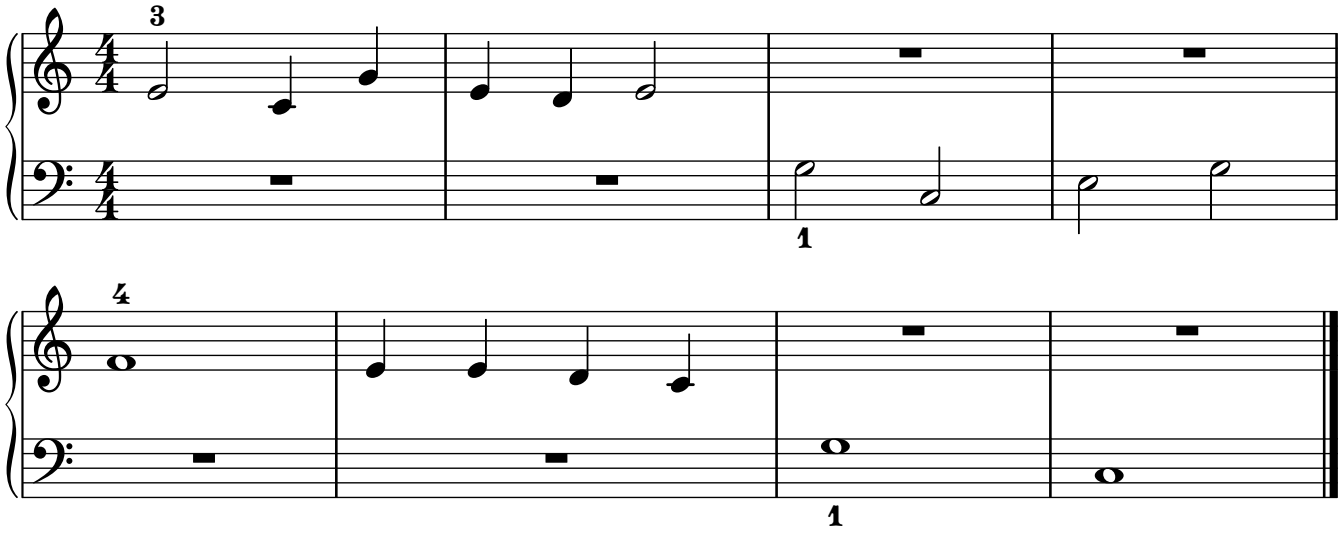
♩ = 66

Eight-bar phrases with the hands taking turns, each moving between its two positions.

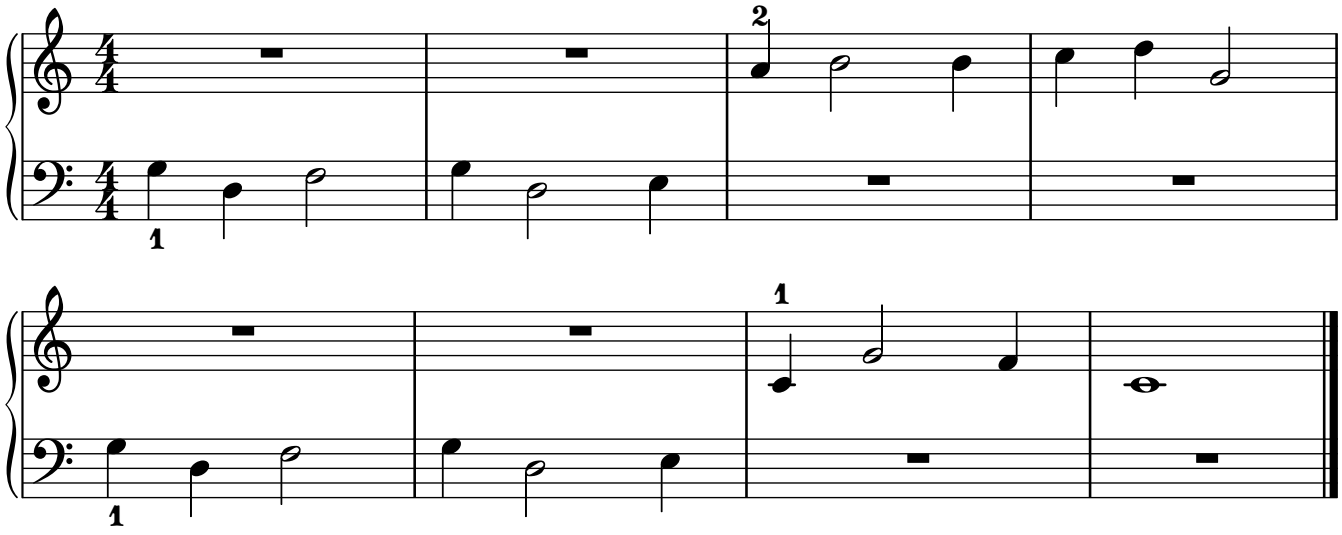
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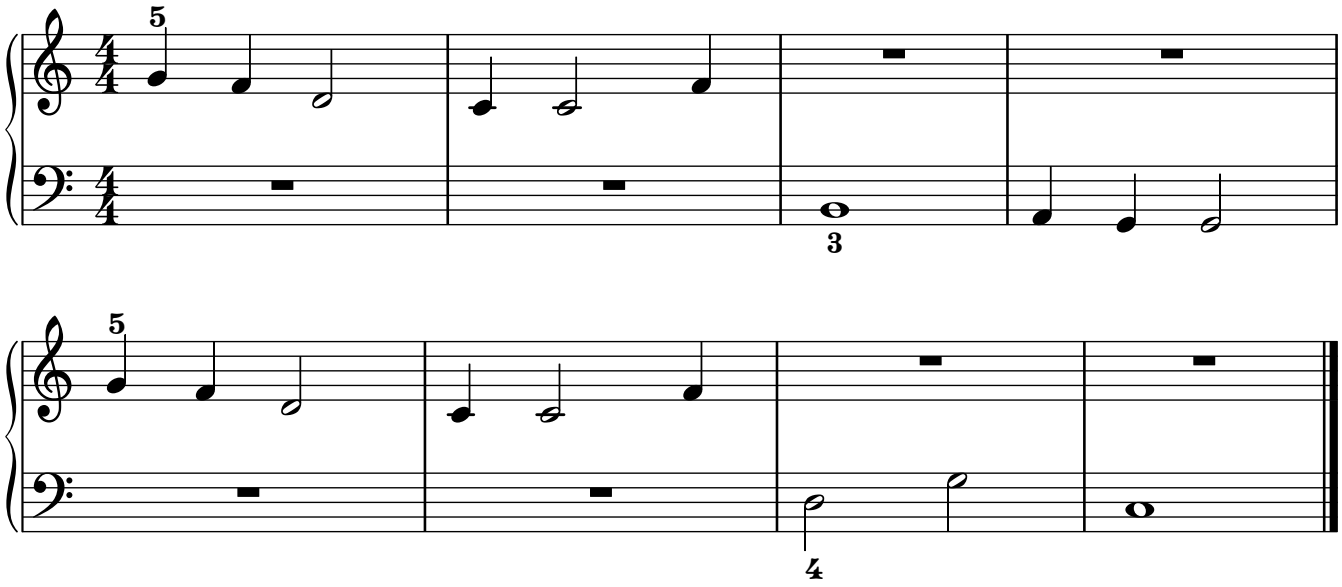
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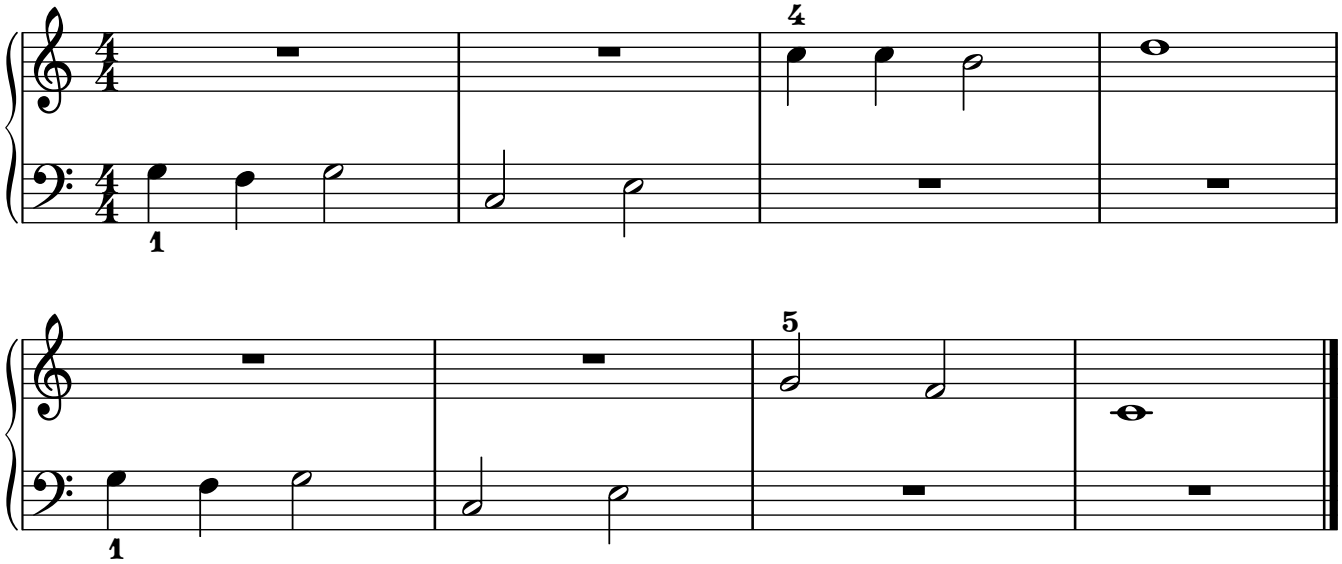


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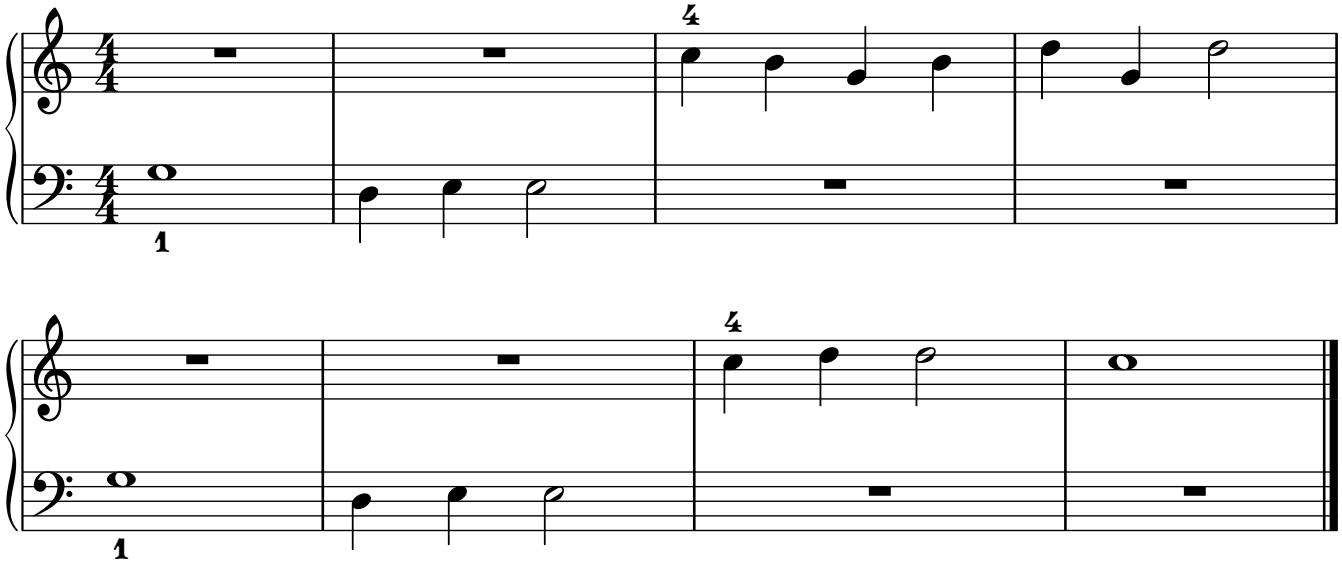


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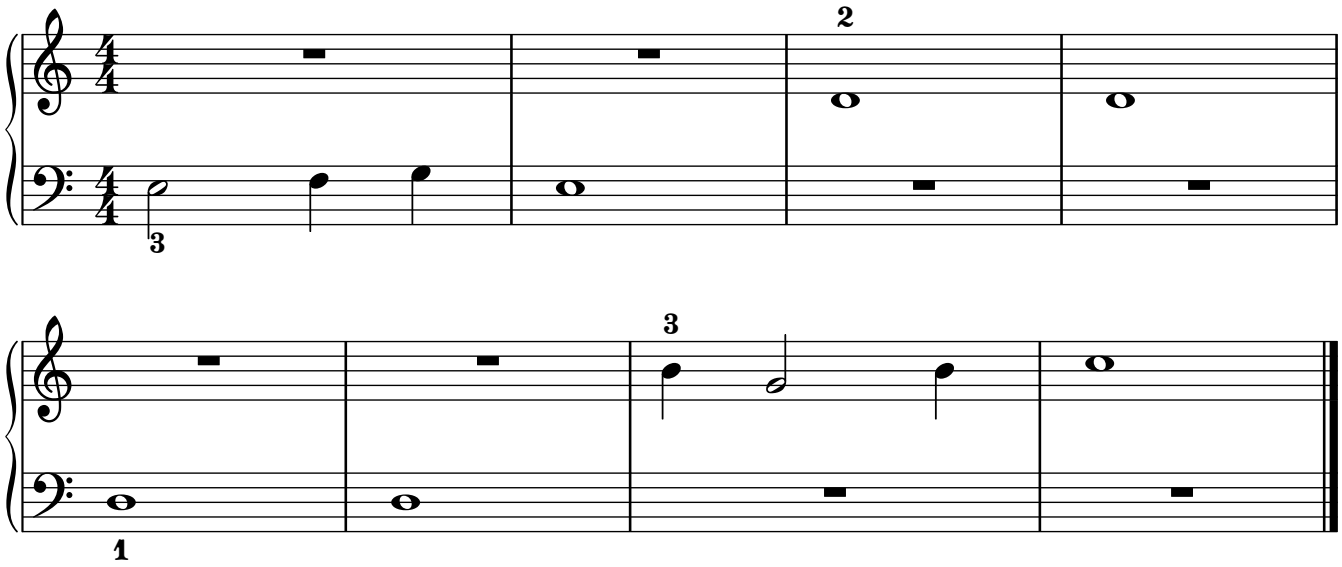
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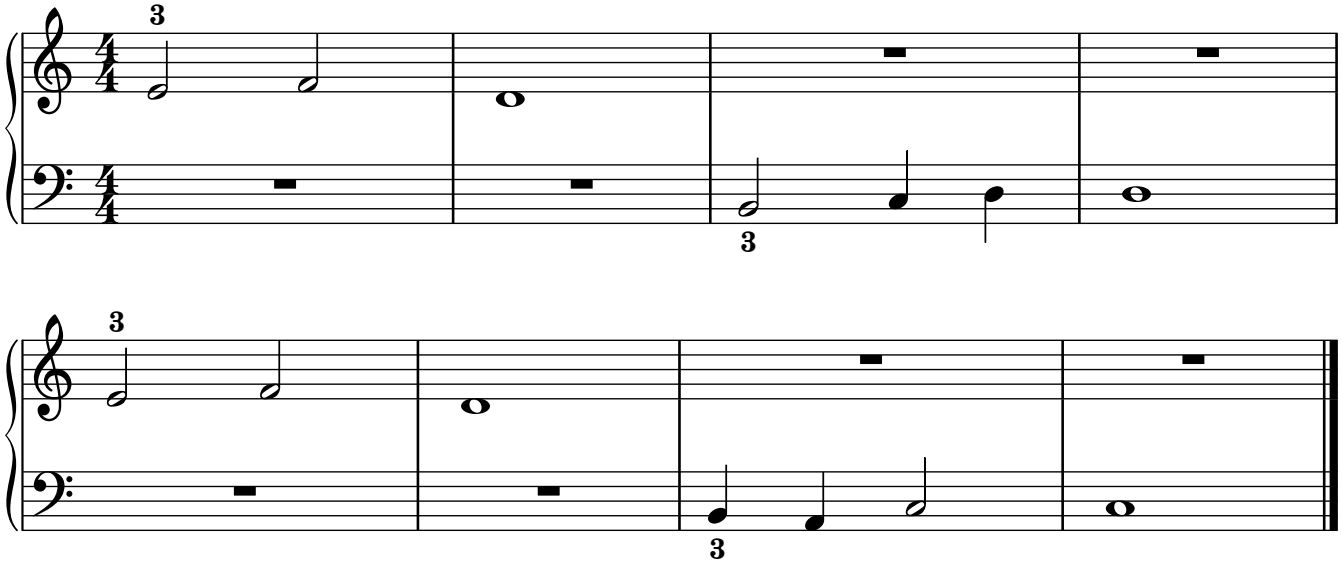
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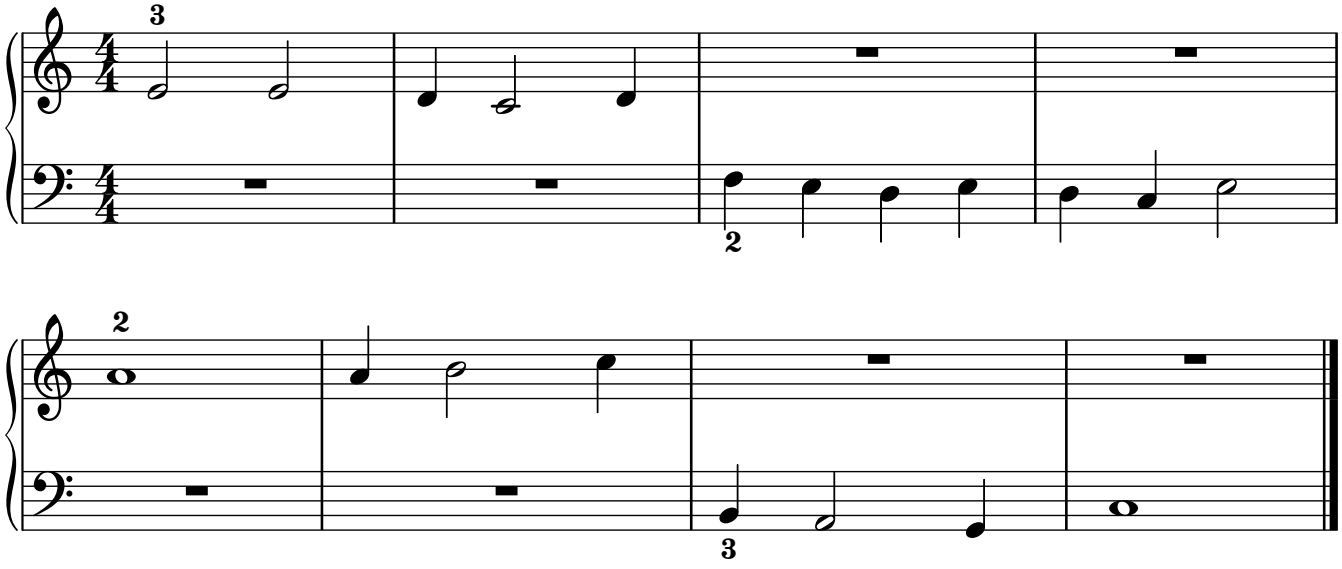


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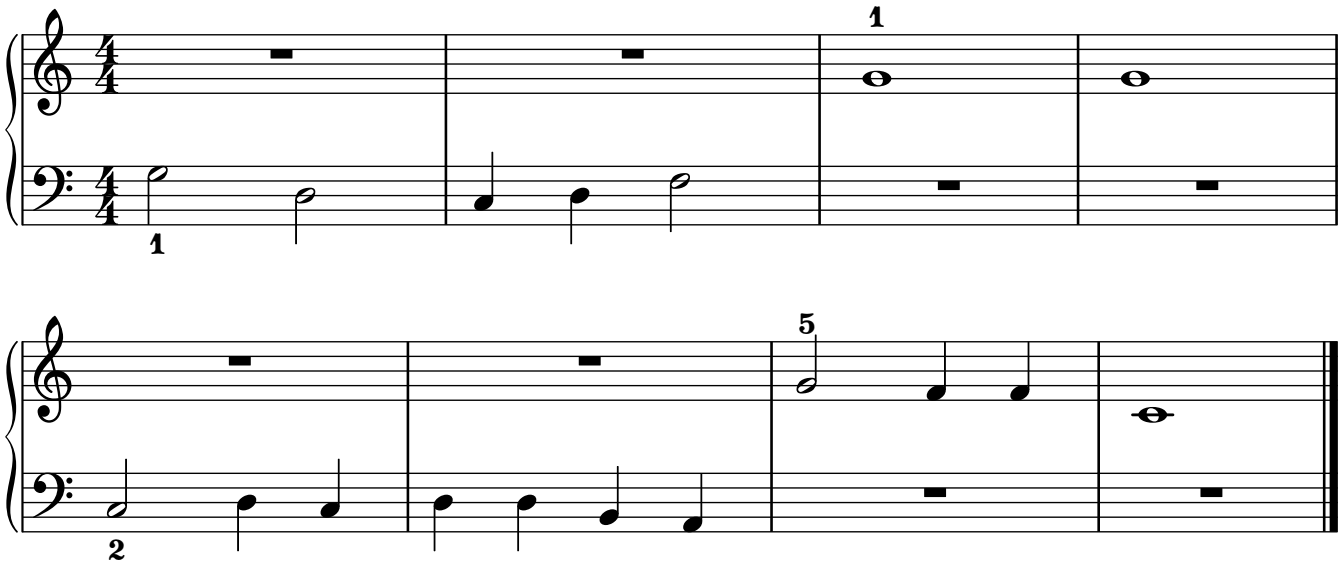


☐ **1.28**



☐ **1.29**



1.30
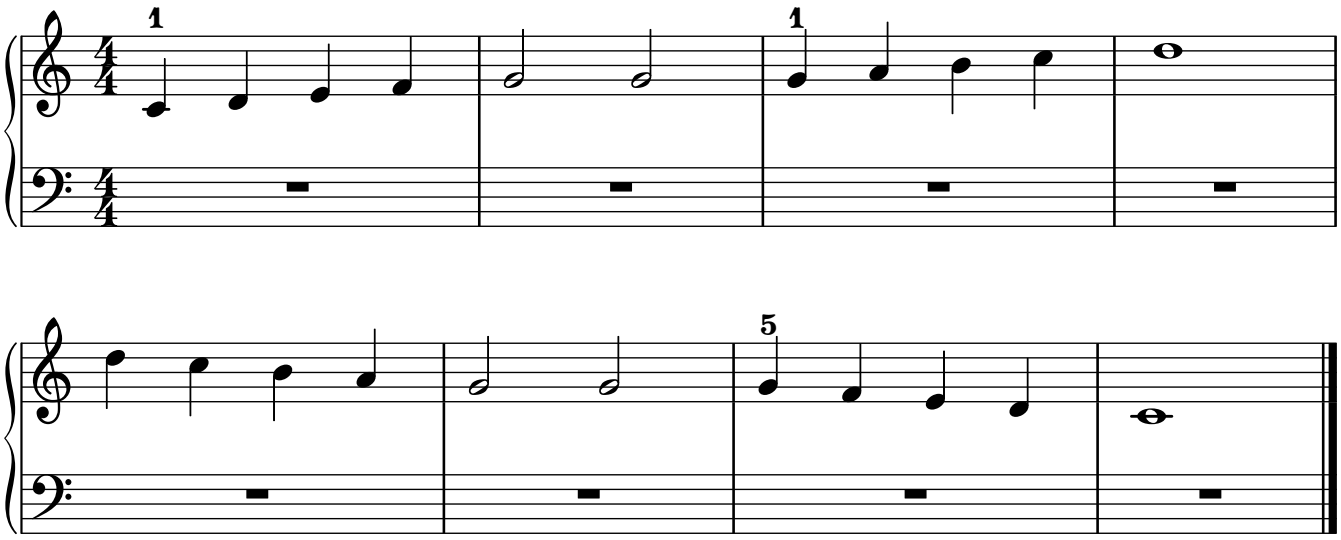


Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Climbing the Stairs ♩ = 72

Original
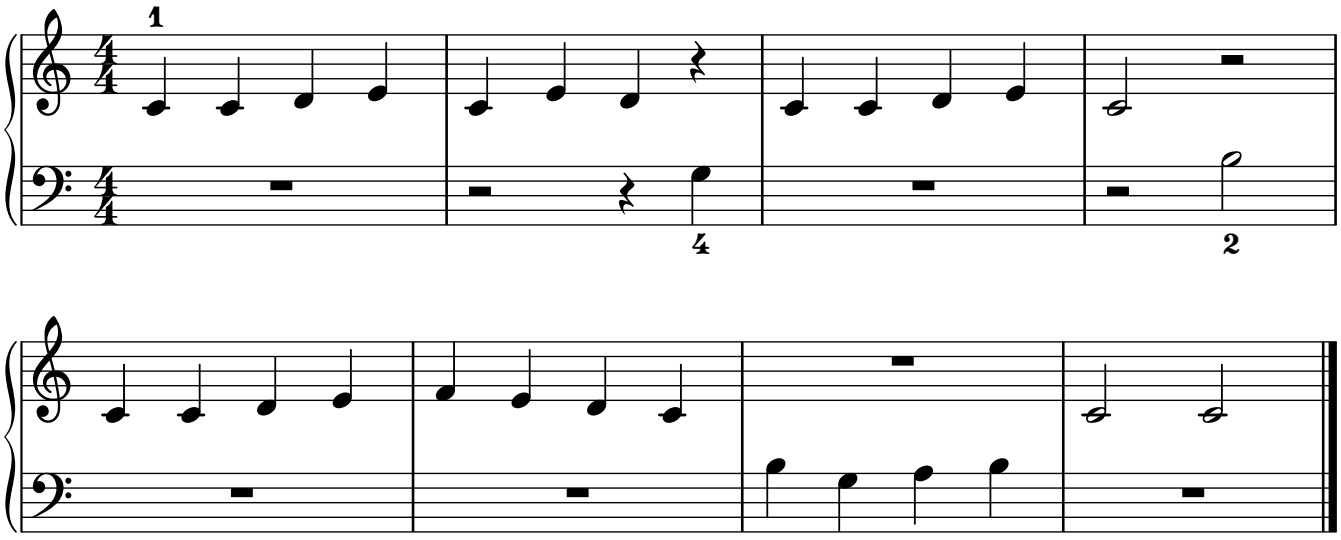
The right hand walks up through C position, shifts so the thumb takes G in bar 3, and walks on to D. It comes back down with another shift in bar 7.



Yankee Doodle ♩ = 84

Traditional American
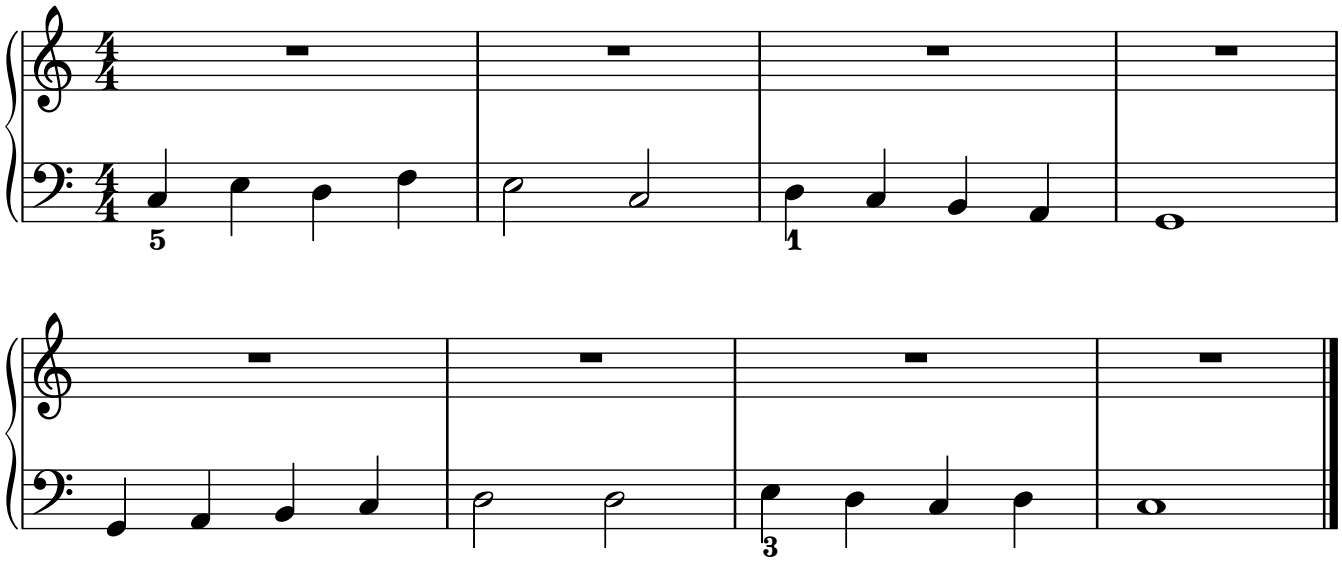
The tune dips below middle C three times. Those notes are written in the bass staff: play them with the left hand in middle C position (thumb on middle C).



Two Homes for the Left Hand ♩ = 72

Original
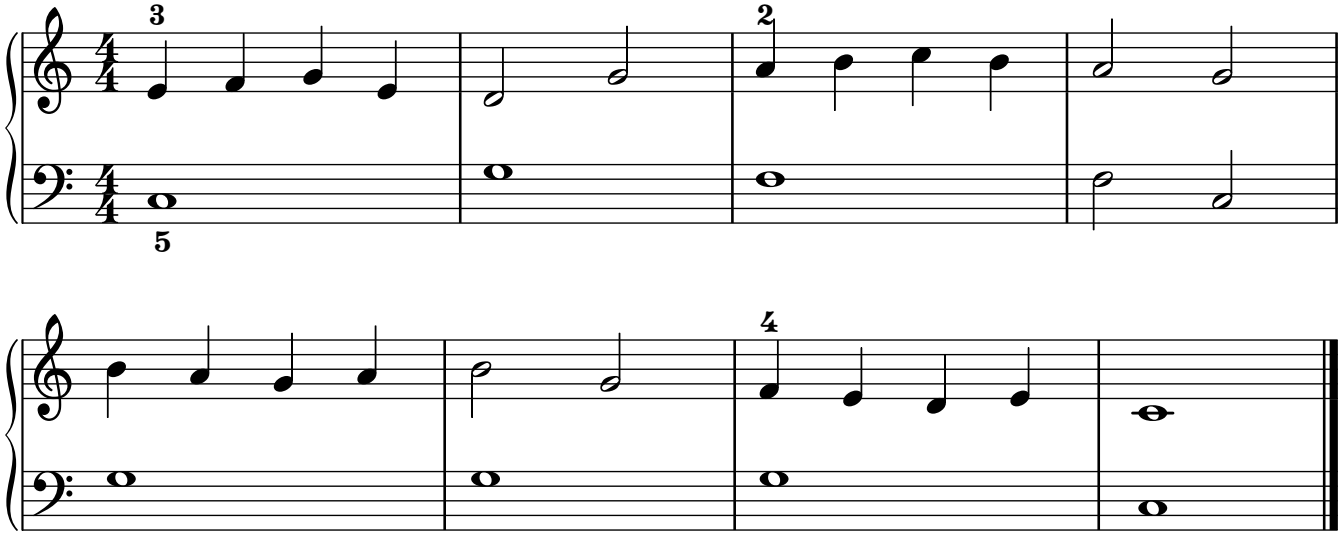
The left hand starts in C position, shifts down to G position in bar 3 (thumb on D), and moves back to C position in bar 7.



Over the Hill ♩ = 72

Original

Hands together. The right hand shifts up to G position in bar 3 and back in bar 7. A new bass note appears in bars 3-4: F, under finger 2.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 2?

- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if every shift lands on time, without looking down for more than an instant.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 2.